

6, The Chinese People's Devout Belief in Lies

Setting aside my personal emotions, another conceptual shift brought about by this monumental "setting to rights of things that have been thrown into disorder" (拨乱反正) is that I can finally say with absolute certainty: **the history of our country over the past fourteen centuries is an entirely corrupted official historiography (佞史).**

Today, anyone who cannot set things to rights from the perspective of interrupted **feudalization** and bureaucratic restoration will continue to be deceived by these lies that have persisted for a millennium. Of the conclusions that Chinese scholars or commoners believe without the slightest doubt, there is almost none that does not require complete re-evaluation.

Bluntly speaking, anyone with even a slight understanding of Chinese society can easily notice one point: when Chinese people view historical issues, they involuntarily and subconsciously "consider things from the emperor's perspective" (为皇上考虑). They fundamentally never reflect on whether their premises are correct; they never suspect whether the centralized **bureaucratic system** itself is right; and they never once consider whether history might have had other possibilities.

Take some simple examples. During China's imperial era, there existed a phenomenon where the supervisory officials and non-resident inspectors dispatched by the emperor to the localities would, over time, gradually morph into long-term resident high-ranking regional officials, eventually even forming independent warlord fiefdoms (割据) by the late stages of the empire.

Regarding this phenomenon, if one observes the explanations provided by Chinese scholars over the years, a highly farcical point emerges: almost everyone, standing from the perspective of the emperor and the court, views this as a "historical counter-current" (历史逆流) that should not have happened. They lament that these regional grandees usurped the court's authority.

They are clearly not the emperor but merely slaves (奴才), yet upon seeing the "imperial discipline faltering" (皇纲不振), they suffer more than if they were being killed! It is indeed the truest portrayal of the old Chinese saying: *"The emperor is not anxious, but the eunuchs are panicking"* (皇帝不急太监急).

I have never seen a single scholar initially suspect whether this bureaucratic centralized system itself was fundamentally flawed. Could it be that under the restored **bureaucratic system**, the court's draconian control and extraction of the localities was itself an economically highly inefficient and irrational system?

The court utilized circulating officials (*Liuguan* / 流官) who neither wanted to understand nor cared about local interests, sucking the marrow from the bones of commoners nationwide just to fatten one single family. Let alone how the wealth plundered and transported to the capital would be squandered, this very extraction itself was economically excruciatingly inefficient.

People should straightforwardly point out that in a **feudal society** dominated by feudal economic relations, a monistic political and economic entity should *never* have hyper-inflated to the scale of the Chinese Empire.

Localities possessing autonomy is not only rational but also represents historical justice (*meaning it aligns with the laws of historical development and is beneficial to social progress*). Conversely, the **restoration-bureaucratic state** itself is deeply reactionary (反动的).

As for non-resident officials morphing into resident high officials and even evolving into independent warlords in the late dynasty, this in itself was a "regression to the norm" (对常态的回归) of history. It is one thing for the emperor to feel heartbroken over it, but what exactly these handfuls of slaves are lamenting over is truly beyond comprehension!

Another issue that gives one a severe headache just listening to it is the so-called issue of establishing the capital—namely, why the capital of the Chinese Empire shifted from Chang'an and Luoyang to Beijing in the later periods.

If you carefully examine Chinese people's explanations for this issue, you will find that although they can list ten thousand benefits of moving the capital to Beijing, almost everyone's discourse is based on a single premise: that China *requires* a "massive capital" (大首都) capable of sustaining a centralized **bureaucratic state**.

But why? Why must there be a massive capital that suppresses the entire nation? Whether now or in the Middle Ages, regimes that opted for small capitals were not in the minority. Why must this possibility be ignored?

Take the most frequently mentioned defense against foreign threats, for example. It is true that the primary foreign enemies of the Chinese Empire during its last millennium clearly shifted toward the northeast, but this absolutely does not mean the capital *had* to be pushed right up to the position of Beijing.

The very reason the capital of the **restoration-bureaucratic empire** had to be established on the frontline against enemies, creating the situation of "the Son of Heaven guarding the nation's gate" (天子守国门), was because this regime inherently *had* to be built upon the extreme suppression of local power to prevent **feudalization** from reoccurring. Consequently, once the capital was far from the primary fortified borders, the empire could not possibly mount an effective response against foreign enemies. And if it forcefully tried to make an effective response, the An Lushan Rebellion and the Jingnan Campaign have already explicitly told posterity what the consequences would be.

However, for a genuinely **feudalized** regime, this was absolutely unnecessary. Because the subordinate **feudal lords** in the border regions could accomplish the task of defending against foreign threats within the framework of the feudal order. In the long run, these vassals would indeed grow powerful through continuous warfare, but that would be a prolonged process, providing the superior feudal rulers ample room for adjustment. They absolutely would not become uncontrollable within a mere one or two generations like China's frontier warlords or vassal princes.

In reality, aside from the fact that the despotic monarch had no choice but to personally guard his own front door, the primary reason for moving the capital to Beijing was that Beijing relied upon the North China Plain—the largest plain in China, fully developed and highly populated during the late imperial era (*China did not possess the Northeast/Manchuria at that time, so the Northeast Plain was naturally out of consideration*). Within the capital region alone, there was a massively colossal amount of social wealth available for the capital to plunder.

Furthermore, Beijing and the Yangtze River's middle and lower reaches—which were increasingly becoming China's most economically developed and active regions—were both situated on the third geographical step of China's terrain. Once the original Sui-Tang Grand Canal was straightened, the capital of this **bureaucratic empire**—Beijing—could continuously devour the wealth of the

Jiangnan region via water transport (漕运). Ever since the Central Plains regimes of the Song Dynasty abandoned Chang'an and Luoyang in favor of Kaifeng, this trend remained consistent.

Bluntly put, moving the capital to Beijing was nothing more than the despotic monarch choosing a location that was most convenient for exploiting the commoners of the entire realm, while simultaneously being forced to protect his own property.

That a bunch of Chinese people would actually try to find "rationality" in such a glaringly obvious atrocity—do they have some sort of Stockholm Syndrome? As slaves, they are terrified that their master cannot abuse them efficiently enough. When the master finds a better method to oppress them, they actually applaud and cheer, shouting "The Emperor is infinitely wise" (皇上圣明)!

Is there a second nation in the world this pathetic (贱)? To actually extract a sense of happiness, satisfaction, and superiority from being a slave—I now truly believe that Lu Xun's words were not empty at all.

Even more bizarre than this absurd "supremacism of superiors" (唯上主义) is that Chinese scholars and commoners are often addicted to issues that would *only* exist in China. They loudly cheer for the conspiracies and Machiavellian machinations (阴谋和权术) of emperors, officials, and concubines, as if they themselves, mere slaves, share in the glory.

These issues include, but are not limited to, palace struggles (宫斗), wars of succession (夺嫡), partisan strife (党争), and eunuch interference (宦官).

How many have earnestly pointed out how many innocent lives were lost, how much social wealth was incinerated, and how much destruction was inflicted upon social production by the infighting of the rulers under this bureaucratic system?

Suppose China had normally embarked upon the path of **feudalization** like Europe and Japan, becoming a normal class society of the feudal period, devoid of a destructive bureaucratic system, possessing clear feudal inheritance laws, with lords of all ranks consolidating relationships through intermarriage—how on earth could those aforementioned perverse, unnatural issues possibly exist?

The fact is, **feudalized** Europe and Japan simply did not have this sheer abundance of rot that inflicted such colossal harm upon society.

This precisely echoes a popular saying on the Chinese internet: "**The problems the Chinese people or the Chinese government are most adept at 'solving' are exactly the problems that others never encounter at all, problems that were entirely spawned by themselves.**"

Once a problem appears to be slightly alleviated (*though in reality, because these social problems were inherently spawned by the bureaucratic system, there is obviously zero possibility of ever solving them*), this "governance capability" perversely becomes something worth boasting about, transforming into a symbol of the greatness of the leader and the superiority of the system.

Such is the tragedy of my country and my people.

6, 中国人民对于谎言的笃信

抛开我个人的情绪不谈, 这次重大的拨乱反正带来的一个观念上的变化还在于我终于可以十分确定地说: 我国过去十四个世纪的历史都是佞史。今天谁如果不能从封建化中断官僚复辟的角度进行拨乱反

正，谁就还要被这些持续了千百年的谎言所欺骗。凡是中国的学者或者老百姓所深信不疑的结论，几乎没有一个不需要重新看待的。毫不客气地讲，只要对中国的社会有所了解的人都很容易注意到一点，那就是中国人看待历史问题的时候总是不自觉“为皇上考虑”，他们根本不去思考自己的假定对不对，不去怀疑中央集权官僚制度本身是否是正确的，从来也不想历史到底有没有别的可能性。

就拿一些简单的例子来说吧，比如中国帝制时期存在一种现象也就是皇帝派往地方的监察官员和非常驻的巡视员会随着时间推移逐渐变成长期驻扎在地方的高级地方官，乃至在帝国末期形成割据。关于这样一个现象如果看到中国学者这么多年来解释就会发现一个非常可笑的地方，那就是几乎每个人都站在皇帝和朝廷的角度认为这种现象是不应该发生的“历史逆流”，哀叹封疆大吏窃取了朝廷的权威，明明自己不是皇帝而是奴才，看到“皇纲不振”却比杀了他还难受，的确是中国的古话“皇帝不急太监急”最真切的写照。我从来没有见到任何一个学者在一开始就去怀疑是不是这种官僚制的中央集权体制本身就有问题，有没有可能在复辟之后的官僚制度下，朝廷对于地方如此严苛的管控和汲取本身就是经济上效率极低的不合理制度呢？朝廷用不想了解，也不在乎当地利益的流官把全国各地的百姓敲骨吸髓以肥一家，且不说那些被掠夺到首都的财富会被如何浪费，光是这种抽取在经济上就是极其低效的。人们应该直截了当地指出，在以封建经济关系为主导的封建社会，一元化的政治和经济体本来就不应该膨胀到中华帝国这样的规模，地方拥有自主权不但是合理的，而且是历史正义的（这里是说符合历史发展规律，并且有益于社会进步），反之复辟官僚国家本身就是反动的。至于不常驻官员变成常驻地方的高官甚至在王朝后期演变成成为割据军阀，这本身就是对历史常态的一种“回归”，皇帝痛心疾首则罢了，三两奴才真不知道有什么好哀叹的！

另一个听着最让人头痛的问题就是所谓的建都问题，也就是中华帝国的首都为什么从长安洛阳转移成了后期的北京。如果你仔细看中国人对这一问题的解释，就会发现他们尽管能够列举出一千一万种迁都北京的好处，但是几乎每个人的论述都基于一个前提，那就是中国需要一个能支撑中央集权官僚国家的“大首都”。然而为什么呢？为什么一定要一个压制全国的大首都，不管是在现在还是在中世纪，选择小首都的政权也不在少数，为什么要忽略这种可能性呢？就拿被人最常提起的抵御外患来说，中华帝国在最后一千年的主要外敌明显转向东北方向固然不错，但是这完全不意味着首都就非要抵近到北京这个位置。之所以复辟官僚帝国的首都不得不设在对敌前线营造出“天子守国门”的局面，本身就是这种政权必须建立在对地方权力极端压制以防止封建化再次发生的前提下，因而首都一旦远离主要的设防边境，帝国就不可能对于外敌做出有效反应，如果非要做出有效反应的话，那么安史之乱和靖难之役已经明确地告诉了后人其结果如何。然而对于一个真正的封建化政权而言这是没有绝对必要的事情，因为边境地区的下属封建领主是可以在封建秩序的框架内完成抵御外患的任务的，从长远来看这些诸侯在不断战争中也会变得强大，但是那会是一个漫长的过程，上级的封建统治者有充分的调整余地，绝对不可能像中国的藩镇藩王一样在短短一两代人的时间就变得一发不可收拾。事实上迁都北京除了专制君主不得不亲自守着家门以外，最主要的原因还是北京依托着华北平原这样一个在帝制后期充分开发的，人口极多的，中国最大的平原（那个时候中国还没有东北，自然不考虑东北平原），在京畿地区就有极为庞大的社会财富可供首都掠夺。而且北京与中国日渐形成的经济最为发达活跃的长江中下游地区同处中国地势的第三阶梯，一旦将原有的隋唐大运河截弯取直，就使得北京这个官僚帝国的首都可以通过漕运源源不断吞噬江南地区的财富，从宋代中原政权奔长安洛阳而选择开封以来这个趋势就是一贯的。说白了，迁都北京就是专制君主不得不保护自己家产的同时尽可能选择一个方便剥削全天下百姓的位置。就这样一种显而易见的事，居然有一堆中国人去为其寻找合理性，这是有什么斯德哥尔摩综合征吗？自己作为奴才，唯恐主子不能更好地虐待自己，主子找到了更好的欺压自己的办法便鼓掌叫好，高呼“皇上圣明”，世界上还有第二个民族这么贱吗？做奴隶居然做出了幸福感，满足感和优越感，信知鲁迅之言不虚也。

比这些荒谬的“唯上主义”更加离奇的是，中国的学者和百姓往往沉迷于那些只有中国才会存在的问题，并为皇帝、官员和嫔妃的阴谋和权术大声喝彩，仿佛自己一个奴才也有荣与焉一般，这些问题包括但不限于宫斗、夺嫡、党争和宦官。有几个人认认真真地指出这些官僚体制下统治者的内斗造成了多少无辜者的死亡，销毁了多少社会财富，对社会生产造成了多少破坏？假如中国像欧洲和日本一样正常地走上了封建化道路，成为一个正常的封建时期阶级社会，没有一个破坏性的官僚体制，存在一个明确的封建继承法，各级领主之间通过联姻巩固关系，上面所说的那些逆天的问题又有什么可能会存在？事实就是，封建化的欧洲和日本根本就没有这么多对社会造成极大危害的烂事。这正是应了中国网络上

的那句话：所谓中国人或者中国政府最擅长解决的问题就是那些别人根本遇不到，本来就是他们自己伴生出的社会问题，一旦看起来问题稍有缓和（事实上因为这些社会问题本来就是官僚体制伴生出的，当然也就没有一点解决的可能），那么这种“治理能力”就反倒是值得夸耀的事了，成为领袖伟大和体制优越的象征。吾国吾民之可悲若此。